



ASUS Memo Pad 10

The ASUS Memo Pad 10 is a new ASUS 10-inch tablet with a resolution of 1280x800 and running Android 4.1



320 GP Panorama

A record breaking 320 GigaPixel panorama of London has been released having about 48,640 photos stitched together <http://dgit.in/13rQLaE>

Transcend-ing categories

We talk about storage sector trends and more with Gordon Wu of Transcend Inc.

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We had the opportunity to meet up with Mr. Gordon Wu, Transcend's Regional Head - South Asia, and spoke to him about the company's wide product offerings in India (ranging from portable media players and digital photo frames, through to the entire gamut of storage media) and trends in Indian market.

During our time with Mr. Wu, we were also shown some interesting new products that will be launched in Indian market soon, such as a Wi-Fi enabled SD card for cameras and a portable SSD drive with a USB 3.0 connection.



Mr. Gordon Wu, Regional Head - South Asia, Transcend Inc.

What are your plans in India; what are you concentrating on?

Unlike other competitors, like Sandisk, Kingston and Seagate, what Transcend does is provide a variety of products. We concentrate in India on every single product range, starting from card reader, flash card, pen drive, DRAM, portable hard drive, external DVD player, digital photo frame, MP3 players. But what we did is select very dedicated channel partners who can really promote our products to penetrate into different kinds of markets.

For example right now, we have a lot business coming from conventional markets, like Lamington Road, Nehru Place, SP Road, and we are also dealing with large format retailers, like Croma, Staples, Reliance. We are also dealing with online businesses such as Snapdeal, Flipkart, BestBuy and eBay. We also have a corporate business, a digital business and SI business.

So essentially, our plans in India right now are to concentrate on selecting the right channel partners, enhancing our relationship with them, to better penetrate the various markets.

I wanted to know some India market demand trends and figures from you, starting with DRAM. How well does DRAM sell in India, especially performance RAM – is India a lucrative market for you in this sphere?

India is a big market, no doubt – growing in PC and growing in mobile. India today contributes to 8 per cent of Transcend's overall revenue, so it's pretty important, and Transcend is a 1 billion U.S dollar annual company, so that is really big. So I would say the DRAM market in India is pretty good. We ship about 1.5 lakh units annually in India.

Commonly, what are the capacities of SSDs that sell best in India?

SSDs are not really selling well here in India actually, because of the prices, and the market is not mature yet, worldwide. So in India, SSDs aren't selling a lot, but you can say 64GB and 128GB are the most common models. We do sell a lot of SSDs to enterprises and industries, usually 32GB and 64GB.

The same question for pen drives, flash cards, and external hard drives.

Pen drives are big. But the fastest growing

market in terms of maturity is microSD card. Right now, we ship roughly 1 million pieces of flash cards in retail packs. Pen drives we ship roughly 3.5 lakh to 4 lakh units. Right now, according to the CMR reports, we are in the top three position in India for pen drives. For flash cards we are number one. In 2012 Q2, our flash card market share was 31 per cent in India, and pen drives was 16 per cent. In hard drives, we are behind Seagate and WD, and every month we ship roughly 12k pieces in India. The MP3 market is shrinking, but we are still number two, behind Philips.

Last year, the mainstream capacity for pen drives was 4GB, this year, it's 8GB definitely, and moving to 16GB. By the second half of the year, I think the mainstream will be 16GB, with 32GB also selling well. For hard drives, 2.5-inch 1TB is currently the mainstream capacity. Flash cards have also moved to 8GB and 16GB. There is also a lot of demand for Class 10 and UHS cards, with demand for high-end smartphones and cameras also booming.

The sharp rise in hard drive pricing was a big deal due to the Thailand floods. By when do you think the market will recover fully?

It's actually almost back to normal really. You're right, they had really shot up, but now they are at a reasonable level, and should become much better by the end of the year.

When do you see high capacity SSDs becoming more mainstream?

It's hard to say, but maybe by the end of the year we will see this. SSD price is currently high, and ultrabook demand is not really growing. The other thing is, because tablet PCs are really on the rise right now, people want a tablet like an iPad more than an ultrabook. Also the PC market itself is slowing down. So, I would say not soon, maybe the end of this year.